Claude Practice Questions

Full review set · Questions 1–53 · All answer options labeled A–D

PDF: Open this page in a browser, press **Ctrl+P**, select **Save as PDF**. Correct options are highlighted; questions marked **Review** were answered incorrectly in the supplied results.

Question 1 · Review

An engineer has working first-party Claude API code and must route the same calls through Amazon Bedrock using the current integration. What is true about the request body and event format across these surfaces?

A. The Messages body shape and SSE event format match; mainly the endpoint and model-ID prefix change.

B. Bedrock requires a completely different request schema with no messages array or content blocks.

C. Bedrock returns plain text rather than the JSON content blocks used by the first-party API.

D. The body is identical, but Bedrock disables streaming, so SSE events never appear.

Answer: A. The current Bedrock path keeps the Messages body and SSE format; the endpoint host and model-ID prefix differ.

Question 2

A compliance team must record every tool result to an immutable audit log without changing whether any tool runs. Which hook design best meets this need?

A. PreToolUse hook that blocks each tool until logging confirms success.

B. Stop hook that logs only the final response once per turn.

C. Memory-file rule asking the model to log its own individual tool results.

D. PostToolUse hook that writes each executed tool result to the audit log.

Answer: D. PostToolUse runs after each tool and cannot block execution, so it audits without changing tool behavior.

Question 3

Claude Code is in accept-edits mode, removing per-action approval prompts. How can irreversible shell commands still be blocked deterministically before they run?

A. PostToolUse hook that only logs the command after execution.

B. System-prompt instruction politely asking the model to be careful.

C. PreToolUse hook returning deny or ask before the command runs.

D. Plan mode, which proposes actions but cannot block accept-edits execution.

Answer: C. PreToolUse fires before execution and can enforce policy deterministically.

Question 4

An agent uses extended thinking and tools, but requests fail when tool_choice is any. What change resolves the error while keeping thinking on?

A. Keep any but remove every thinking block from message history.

B. Set tool_choice to auto or none; only those work with thinking on.

C. Switch tool_choice to tool to force one named tool.

D. Lower effort so any becomes valid alongside thinking.

Answer: B. With extended thinking and tools, only auto or none is permitted.

Question 5

Why can a client not send additional input over the same open channel while a Claude streamed response is arriving?

A. Streaming is full-duplex, so mid-stream messages are merely rate-limited.

B. Streaming becomes bidirectional after content_block_stop.

C. SSE is one-directional, server-to-client over one HTTP response, not full-duplex.

D. Streaming uses a WebSocket that buffers client writes until completion.

Answer: C. New input requires a new request; SSE has no client-to-server channel.

Question 6

Anthropic runs the agent loop, but its tools must query an internal database behind the corporate firewall. Which deployment shape fits?

A. Anthropic-hosted, because managed sandboxes can reach any private network.

B. Anthropic-hosted, because managed hosting always includes firewall tunneling.

C. Self-hosted, since tool execution runs on the customer's infrastructure.

D. Either shape, because tool location does not affect deployment choice.

Answer: C. Customer-side tool execution can reach private resources behind the firewall.

Question 7

A bank chatbot must refuse investment advice, a deployment-specific rule. Why is relying only on built-in safety training insufficient?

A. Built-in safety cannot refuse any request without an explicit system prompt.

B. Safety training governs universal harms, not this deployment's own content rules.

C. Safety training applies only to the API surface, not chatbot deployments.

D. The model always answers investment questions regardless of guardrails.

Answer: B. Product-specific restrictions require the developer's own guardrail layer.

Question 8

A service sometimes receives schema-invalid responses. It validates once and errors to the user. What best improves reliability without abandoning the schema?

A. Raise temperature to make outputs more varied.

B. On failure, re-prompt with the specific error to correct.

C. Retry the identical request unchanged until it passes.

D. Remove validation and accept whatever the model returns.

Answer: B. Generate, validate, then provide the specific error for correction.

Question 9

A team pins a model ID, versions prompts against frozen evals, commits CLAUDE.md and settings.json, and keeps secrets out of source control. Which artifact stays uncommitted?

A. Project settings.json, because shared permissions and hooks should not be exposed.

B. The pinned model ID, to avoid preventing migration.

C. settings.local.json, holding personal git-ignored overrides.

D. The frozen evaluation set, because fixtures change too often.

Answer: C. Personal local overrides stay uncommitted; shared configuration and evals are versioned.

Question 10

A request exceeds the context window. What counts against that token budget?

A. The latest user message alone; prior turns are stored separately.

B. System prompt and user message, excluding tool results.

C. System prompt, history, tool definitions, tool results, and current generation.

D. Output tokens alone; input history does not occupy the window.

Answer: C. All content the model attends to competes for the same context budget.

Question 11

For a classification job with a fixed budget, Haiku clears the accuracy bar while Opus scores only marginally higher at far greater cost. Which choice is best?

A. Pick Haiku since it clears the accuracy bar at the lowest cost.

B. Pick Opus because a higher eval score always justifies added cost.

C. Pick Sonnet as a compromise even though Haiku already passes.

D. Pick Opus because classification accuracy should never be compromised.

Answer: A. Choose the cheapest tier that meets the required quality bar within budget.

Question 12

Which artifacts should be committed together so a future checkout reproduces how an application behaved at a release?

A. The pinned model ID and versioned prompt tied to that release.

B. Prompt-cache contents and the most recent captured tool results.

C. Production response transcripts from that week.

D. A floating model alias and the current working prompt draft.

Answer: A. Reproducibility depends on both the exact model and prompt.

Question 13

A developer closed a Claude Code session and wants to continue today with the same accumulated context. What restores it?

A. Open a new session; it automatically recalls the last one.

B. Run /init to regenerate the earlier conversation state.

C. Resume the prior session so its accumulated context reopens.

D. Rely on compaction to preserve context across restart.

Answer: C. Resuming is the continuity mechanism; new sessions start without prior conversation context.

Question 14

A long conversation grows by appending stable turns. With at most four cache_control markers, how should caching maximize reuse?

A. Place all four breakpoints on the first turn and never move them.

B. Cache only the fixed system prompt.

C. Add one new breakpoint per turn until exceeding the limit.

D. Move the breakpoint to the latest stable turn each round.

Answer: D. Advancing the marker extends the cached prefix as the conversation grows.

Question 15

Which framework centers on an Agent object, typed dependencies injected through RunContext, and validated structured results?

A. LangGraph, with StateGraph and reducers.

B. PydanticAI, built by the Pydantic team around validated outputs and RunContext.

C. Strands, a model-driven loop of model, tools, and prompt.

D. Claude Agent SDK, whose query() runs a standalone agent loop.

Answer: B. Agent, typed dependencies, and RunContext are PydanticAI's signature constructs.

Question 16 · Review

A team wants one typed shortcut any member can invoke on demand to run a repeated release checklist. Which Claude Code mechanism fits, and where does it live?

A. A slash-command file in the project commands directory, invoked on demand by anyone.

B. A CLAUDE.md rule loaded every turn so the checklist always applies automatically.

C. A skill that triggers only when its description matches the current task.

D. A subagent spawned each release to run the checklist in isolation.

Answer: A. A project slash command is a shared, manually invoked repeatable workflow.

Question 17

A subagent formats data in the wrong currency. The manager knew the target currency earlier, and the subagent's tools and prompt were otherwise correct. What is most likely?

A. Subagents cannot format currency without a dedicated conversion tool.

B. The currency was not passed in the delegated task, so the subagent could not see it.

C. The manager's full context propagated, but the subagent ignored it.

D. Subagents reset currency to a platform default.

Answer: B. Subagents are context-isolated and receive only what the task passes.

Question 18

A headless CI agent runs database tools. Destructive queries must be blocked deterministically and every executed result audited. Which configuration meets both needs?

A. Memory-file instructions telling the agent to refuse destructive queries and log results.

B. PreToolUse ask hook on every query, relying on a reviewer to approve in CI.

C. PreToolUse deny hook for destructive queries plus PostToolUse logging hook in settings.json.

D. One PostToolUse hook that blocks destructive queries and logs results.

Answer: C. PreToolUse blocks before execution; PostToolUse audits afterward. Headless CI cannot rely on interactive approval.

Question 19

A five-minute cache write costs 1.25× base input price and each read costs 0.1×. Why does a large prefix need enough reuse to pay off?

A. The write is free, so any single reuse immediately saves money.

B. Each 0.1× read saves against base, and enough reads offset the 1.25× write.

C. Reads cost more than base, so fewer reuses are always cheaper.

D. Caching always lowers cost, regardless of reuse count.

Answer: B. Accumulated read savings must exceed the one-time write premium.

Question 20

Tool A returns JSON that is fed verbatim into the next tool-selection step and could contain adversarial text. What handling is best?

A. Label tool A's output as untrusted and keep next actions least-privileged.

B. Treat it as trusted because it came from the application's own tool.

C. Inline it with instructions so the model weighs it equally.

D. Skip validation because JSON cannot contain injection text.

Answer: A. Tool output can contain adversarial strings; delimit it as data and constrain follow-on actions.

Question 21

A team wants to distribute slash commands, a skill, and a hook as one installable unit across many repositories. Which mechanism fits?

A. Package them as a plugin and install it across the repositories.

B. Paste each command and hook into every repository's settings by hand.

C. Add each piece individually as user-level files on every developer's machine.

D. Convert them into one CLAUDE.md rule block per repository.

Answer: A. A plugin bundles extensions as one installable and manageable unit.

Question 22

A long-running, tool-heavy agent has rising cost, latency, and loss of focus. How should the team keep high-signal content in view?

A. Rely on a larger context window and trust the model to discard stale content.

B. Restart every turn and reload the full history from logs.

C. Raise reasoning effort and max_tokens so long context processes faster.

D. Prune tool output, compact history, and isolate subtasks into separate subagents.

Answer: D. Context must be actively managed; stale history is not automatically discarded.

Question 23 · Review

Does enabling SDK streaming change the underlying wire protocol compared with raw REST?

A. The SDK negotiates a WebSocket upgrade unavailable to raw REST.

B. Wire behavior stays identical Server-Sent Events; the SDK just parses them.

C. SDK streaming switches to faster binary framing.

D. The SDK batches chunks server-side and delivers one final payload.

Answer: B. Both use the same HTTP SSE stream; the SDK parses and accumulates events.

Question 24

Why is it a security risk to paste a live API key into the system prompt?

A. System prompts cannot hold enough characters for a full key.

B. The key will be rejected unless passed as a header.

C. Keys in prompts are automatically rotated and become invalid.

D. Anything in a prompt can surface in output or a stored transcript.

Answer: D. Secrets belong in environment variables or a secret manager, outside prompts and logs.

Question 25

Why does Claude Code not activate reusable-instructions Markdown as a skill when the YAML frontmatter is omitted?

A. Skills must be in the user commands directory, not the project.

B. Skills must be listed in settings.json permissions.

C. Skills require valid frontmatter with name and description to be recognized.

D. Skills need an accompanying bundled script.

Answer: C. Frontmatter lets Claude Code identify and match a skill; scripts are optional.

Question 26

A developer sets tool_choice to none but still provides tool definitions, expecting zero tool-related token cost. Which statement is correct?

A. Providing tools adds tool-use system-prompt tokens regardless of tool_choice.

B. Setting tool_choice to none removes all tool token overhead.

C. Tool definitions are billed only when a tool is called.

D. Overhead applies only with tool_choice any or a forced specific tool.

Answer: A. The base overhead applies whenever tools are supplied; omit tools for zero overhead.

Question 27

What is the accurate correction to describing CLAUDE.md as durable memory that persists application state between runs?

A. It automatically records each session's results for the next session.

B. It stores state only until context compaction.

C. It persists state like an external memory store the agent writes.

D. It is static developer-authored rules in context, not runtime state.

Answer: D. Self-updating durable state requires an external memory mechanism.

Question 28

How can developers and CI use the same reviewed prompt version and pinned model ID, with changes reviewed before production?

A. Check the pinned model ID and versioned prompt into shared source control.

B. Let each developer set the model and prompt locally.

C. Store the prompt only in production.

D. Hardcode the ID and edit it directly in production.

Answer: A. Shared tracked configuration makes changes reviewable and keeps environments consistent.

Question 29

What are all valid permissionDecision values a PreToolUse hook can return?

A. allow, deny, and defer.

B. allow, deny, and ask.

C. allow, deny, and escalate.

D. allow, deny, ask, and defer.

Answer: D. The complete set has four values: allow, deny, ask, and defer.

Question 30 · Review

A support assistant's per-session cost climbs as long multi-turn chats grow, even though replies stay short. What action most directly reduces the cost?

A. Prune or compact accumulated history, since growing input drives session cost.

B. Shorten generated replies further because output tokens dominate.

C. Lower max_tokens so the model cannot produce long answers.

D. Use a one-hour cache TTL for constantly shifting recent turns.

Answer: A. Each turn resends growing history, so accumulated input is the cost driver.

Question 31

A 40,000-token document prefix is reused about every 20 minutes, but the default five-minute cache expires between uses. What best improves economics?

A. Set the one-hour TTL so entries survive between uses, at a 2.0× write cost.

B. Keep five minutes and resend the full prefix uncached each time.

C. Add more than four cache_control breakpoints to extend lifetime.

D. Move the document into a header to bypass expiry.

Answer: A. The one-hour TTL matches the reuse cadence; repeated discounted reads amortize the write premium.

Question 32

Map mechanisms for: proprietary CRM writes, current public-web information, and shipping quotes shared with a partner's non-Claude client.

A. Custom CRM tool, custom web scraper, and a Skill shared with the partner.

B. Custom CRM tool, built-in web_search, and MCP server for shared quotes.

C. MCP server for CRM, web_search, and custom tool for the partner.

D. Skill for CRM, MCP server for web data, and built-in tool for the partner.

Answer: B. Use the mechanism suited to each task: custom tool, web search, and interoperable MCP server.

Question 33

Beyond keeping the parent context clean, what benefit does isolating a subtask in a subagent provide?

A. It ensures the subagent can never produce an incorrect intermediate result.

B. It shares every subagent error directly into the manager's window.

C. It removes any need for the manager to synthesize returned results.

D. It limits the blast radius of a bad step to the isolated subagent.

Answer: D. Isolation contains a faulty intermediate result; it does not eliminate errors or synthesis.

Question 34

Why can a partner's non-Claude model client use the same tools as a Claude app through MCP?

A. MCP is an open, model-agnostic standard any compliant client can speak.

B. MCP is a Claude-proprietary interface optimized only for Anthropic models.

C. MCP automatically converts non-Claude clients into Claude clients.

D. MCP tools run only when called by a Claude model.

Answer: A. Any compliant client can connect to the same server; MCP is model-agnostic.

Question 35

A plugin workflow silently produces wrong output for some teammates despite identical files. Before escalating a suspected model regression, what is the best first move?

A. Trace a failing run and check for an unresolved plugin dependency.

B. Immediately escalate a model regression because identical files rule out dependencies.

C. Retry repeatedly because the failure is transient.

D. Rewrite the plugin as CLAUDE.md rules on every machine.

Answer: A. Trace first and isolate the layer; dependencies can differ outside the plugin files.

Question 36 · Review

An integration targeting Opus 4.5 uses budget_tokens and custom temperature. What changes are required when migrating to Opus 4.8?

A. Keep budget_tokens and temperature unchanged.

B. Keep temperature but replace budget_tokens with a larger adaptive budget.

C. Switch thinking to adaptive and drop the non-default temperature.

D. Drop only temperature and keep budget_tokens, which Opus 4.8 requires.

Answer: C. Opus 4.8 requires adaptive thinking and rejects non-default temperature; remove legacy budget_tokens.

Question 37

In accept-edits mode, a CLAUDE.md instruction against destructive commands was bypassed. What is the reliable fix?

A. Strengthen the CLAUDE.md wording.

B. Switch to a larger model.

C. Add a PreToolUse hook that deterministically denies that command.

D. Use PostToolUse to reverse the command after execution.

Answer: C. PreToolUse denies before execution; prompts and post-execution hooks cannot reliably prevent it.

Question 38

A production agent processes untrusted customer emails and can issue refunds. Which design best provides defense in depth against injected instructions causing an unauthorized refund?

A. Delimit untrusted email, scope the refund tool with least privilege, and gate high-value refunds behind approval.

B. Add a firm system-prompt instruction never to issue fraudulent refunds.

C. Upgrade to Opus so it reasons more carefully about suspicious emails.

D. Log every refund so fraudulent ones can be reversed afterward.

Answer: A. Boundaries, least privilege, and approval gates layer preventive controls.

Question 39

In the MCP client-server model, which statement correctly assigns the roles?

A. The client connects to the server, which exposes tools, resources, and prompts.

B. The server spawns the client and injects tools into its context.

C. Client and server roles are interchangeable at each request.

D. The server runs the model while the client only forwards raw user text.

Answer: A. The client connects and consumes capabilities provided by the server.

Question 40 · Review

How can a raw Messages API caller reproduce Claude Code's Plan Mode review gate?

A. Set a Messages API parameter plan_mode=true.

B. The API enables Plan Mode automatically whenever tools are provided.

C. Plan Mode is a Claude Code feature; API callers must build their own approval gate.

D. Import settings.json at request time to transfer Plan Mode.

Answer: C. The Messages API has no Plan Mode equivalent; implement review in application code.

Question 41

A database tool marks every field required, a connection string is inline in the prompt, retrieved tickets sit beside instructions, and batch results are matched by list position. Which fixes should be prioritized?

A. Add more required fields, keep the credential inline, and trust ticket text as instructions.

B. Move the credential into the system prompt, make all fields optional, and rely on ordering.

C. Load credentials from a secret store, require no-default fields, delimit tickets as data, and match by custom_id.

D. Cache the prefix, force tool_choice any, and log the connection string.

Answer: C. This addresses secrets, schema requirements, untrusted input, and reliable batch matching.

Question 42

A pen tester bypasses keyword sanitization and tags intended to stop prompt injection. What should the team conclude?

A. Tag wrapping likely failed and should be removed.

B. Injection is unstoppable, so no further controls are useful.

C. The pen test was invalid because real users behave differently.

D. Sanitization is one defense-in-depth layer; pair it with least privilege and output checks, not treat it as a full cure.

Answer: D. Filtering reduces risk but should be combined with additional controls.

Question 43

A team must summarize 200,000 archived records overnight. Cost matters more than latency. What is the best processing choice?

A. Fire 200,000 concurrent real-time requests regardless of cost.

B. Submit the work to the Message Batches API for 50% cost within the 24-hour window.

C. Process sequentially with one blocking call per record.

D. Use one streaming request for the entire record set.

Answer: B. Batches fit bulk offline work when a 24-hour completion window is acceptable.

Question 44

Choose surfaces for analyst chat, unattended nightly CI summaries, and a scripted repository-editing agent.

A. claude.ai for chat, Claude Code headless for CI, and Agent SDK for the file-editing agent.

B. Messages API alone for all three, since it provides each surface identically.

C. Claude Desktop for every case.

D. claude.ai for the unattended CI job because saved history makes it reproducible.

Answer: A. Match interactive chat, unattended automation, and programmatic file editing to their respective surfaces.

Question 45

When deciding which parameters of a new tool schema to mark required, what is the correct principle?

A. Require every field to guarantee complete arguments.

B. Require no fields so the model never stops to ask.

C. Require fields alphabetically.

D. Require only fields that have no safe default value.

Answer: D. Require only values that cannot safely be defaulted.

Question 46

A batch tool processes 20 records: 12 succeed and 8 fail. How should the handler let the model retry only failed records?

A. Return a generic failure so the model reruns the whole batch.

B. Return a structured result reporting successes and the eight failures.

C. Return only successes and silently omit failures.

D. Return raw exception text from the first failed record.

Answer: B. Explicit partial-success reporting scopes retries to the failed subset.

Question 47

A production service migrates from Opus 4.5 to 4.8 and relies on budget_tokens, custom temperature, and assistant prefill. Which plan anticipates the breaking changes?

A. Replace budget_tokens with adaptive thinking, drop temperature and prefill, and regression-test on Opus 4.8.

B. Keep all three parameters unchanged.

C. Only swap the model ID; thinking and sampling configs carry forward.

D. Remove extended thinking because adaptive models cannot reason.

Answer: A. The newer model rejects budget_tokens, non-default temperature, and final-turn prefill.

Question 48

What single criterion most reliably separates a workflow from an agent before implementation?

A. Whether the task calls any tools.

B. Whether output must be schema-validated.

C. Whether the step sequence is known and fixed before the request arrives.

D. Whether the model tier should be Opus, Sonnet, or Haiku.

Answer: C. Fixed steps favor a workflow; runtime model choice of steps favors an agent.

Question 49

A support assistant must decline medical dosing advice and route users to a nurse. Which statement best captures a QA-testable functional requirement?

A. The assistant should be prompted to be careful about medical topics.

B. The assistant must run with output guardrails enabled on Anthropic infrastructure.

C. The assistant must log every medical question for later review.

D. The assistant refuses medical dosing questions and routes the user to a nurse.

Answer: D. A functional requirement states observable behavior QA can verify.

Question 50

Which mechanism applies documented review conventions automatically at the start of every Claude Code session?

A. Project CLAUDE.md rules, loaded at session start and applied every turn.

B. A slash command a reviewer types before each review.

C. A Skill that loads only when its description matches the task.

D. A PreToolUse hook that fires before a specific tool.

Answer: A. CLAUDE.md provides automatically loaded standing guidance.

Question 51

A prompt says “return only valid JSON,” but responses sometimes include a prose preamble. Which statement is accurate?

A. A prose format instruction shapes output but does not guarantee schema conformance.

B. The instruction guarantees JSON if placed in the system prompt.

C. Repeating it in every user turn contractually enforces the format.

D. Lowering effort reliably forces the model to omit the preamble.

Answer: A. Use structured outputs or strict tool use when conformance must be enforced.

Question 52

A finance dashboard extracts dollar figures with structured outputs, but some confidently stated figures are wrong and no errors are raised. How should the pipeline be hardened end to end?

A. Rely on schema alone because guaranteed types ensure correctness.

B. Ask the model for confidence scores and display only high-confidence values.

C. Expand logging and add broad try/except so wrong figures surface as errors.

D. Keep the schema, add a semantic gate grounding figures in the filing and re-prompting, and parse defensively.

Answer: D. Schema checks structure, not truth; grounding and defensive validation address silent semantic errors.

Question 53

A low-privilege reporting agent successfully called an admin-only user-deletion endpoint. The call was fully logged. What most directly prevents recurrence?

A. Add extra fields to the deletion endpoint's log entry.

B. Restrict the reporting agent's identity from the deletion endpoint.

C. Add a prompt line telling the agent never to delete users.

D. Increase alerting frequency so deletion calls are seen sooner.

Answer: B. Remove unnecessary access to enforce the boundary; logging and alerts detect after the fact.

Prepared from the supplied quiz results. Correct answers and review flags reflect the provided answer key.